Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.
OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.
2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand
3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand
2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠4

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠4

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥6

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♦
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠K

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K J 2 ♥ Q 7 5 ♦ Q 10 7 2 ♣ 7 5 3	
♠ A 9 6 ♥ J 10 9 4 ♦ 9 ♣ 10 8 6 4 2	N W E S	♠ 7 4 3 ♥ 8 3 2 ♦ J 6 5 4 3 ♣ A 9
	♠ Q 10 8 5 ♥ A K 6 ♦ A K 8 ♣ K Q J	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♠4

SOUTH expected to open 2♣, then bid 2NT at her second turn.

But NORTH, with 8 points and a balanced hand, responds 2NT, so SOUTH must adapt. She shows her minimum, balanced, 22-point hand by bidding 3NT.

Since SOUTH has just the 8 points minimum that he promised, he passes 3NT.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 10 3 ♥ 10 7 6 3 ♦ 5 4 ♣ J 10 9 8 3	
♠ K 9 8 7 ♥ Q J 8 2 ♦ 9 8 6 ♣ 7 4		♠ A Q J 2 ♥ A K 5 ♦ K Q 7 3 ♣ A 6
	♠ 6 5 4 ♥ 9 4 ♦ A J 10 2 ♣ K Q 5 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2♦	Pass	2NT	Pass
3♣	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by East
Lead: ♠4

EAST has a balanced 23-point hand. He opens 2♣.

With 6 points and two 4-card Majors, WEST can only say 2♦.

EAST shows his minimum hand with a 2NT rebid.

Now WEST bids 3♣. This is not the second negative, but rather it is Stayman.

When EAST shows his ♠ suit WEST bids 4♠.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 8 ♥ K Q 4 ♦ A K Q J 8 6 ♣ K 4	
♠ 9 6 5 4 3 ♥ 10 6 3 ♦ 3 ♣ Q 8 6 2	N W E S	♠ Q J 10 ♥ J 8 2 ♦ 9 5 4 ♣ J 10 9 7
	♠ K 7 2 ♥ A 9 7 5 ♦ 10 7 2 ♣ A 5 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♥
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

7NT by South
Lead: ♥6

NORTH opens 2♣.

SOUTH should just respond 2NT, even with 11 points. The idea is to make a positive response (which forces the partnership to game level), and show extra strength later.

This time there is no need. NORTH should bid 4♣ (Gerber), and SOUTH answers 4♠ for two Aces.

Next NORTH should ask for Kings, and when SOUTH shows one King NORTH should bid 7NT.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

	♠ A K Q 10 2 ♥ 7 4 ♦ 10 4 ♣ 10 8 7 6	
♠ 9 7 3 ♥ 6 2 ♦ Q J 9 8 6 3 ♣ A 4		♠ 8 ♥ A K Q 5 ♦ A K 7 2 ♣ K Q J 3
	♠ J 6 5 4 ♥ J 10 9 8 3 ♦ 5 ♣ 9 5 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
3♦	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♦[2]	Pass	6♦	
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♦ by West
Lead: ♠K

When EAST opens 2♣ WEST has enough strength (9 points) for a positive response. But, because her suit is ♦s, she must jump to 3♦.

EAST thinks slam and uses Blackwood to discover that WEST holds one Ace.

That's all WEST needs to know to bid 6♦.